

The Noble One Hundred and Eight Names of Vajrapāṇi, Together with Dhāraṇī and Mantra

Ārya-Vajrapāṇi-aṣṭottaraśataka-nāma-dhāraṇī-mantra-sahita · Toh 638 · Derge Kangyur

འཕགས་པ་ལག་ན་རྩོམ་མཚན་བར་རྒྱ་བར་རྒྱ་པ་

The Noble One Hundred and Eight Names of Vajrapāṇi, Together with Dhāraṇī and Mantra, known in Sanskrit as the

Ārya-Vajrapāṇi-aṣṭottaraśataka-nāma-dhāraṇī-mantra-sahita and in Tibetan as Pakpa Lakna Dorjé Tsen Gyatsa Gyepa, is a dhāraṇī text devoted to the bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi, the powerful wielder of the thunderbolt who serves as a protector of the Buddhist teaching. The text presents one hundred and eight names of Vajrapāṇi together with his heart-essence mantra and dhāraṇī, the recitation of which is described as causing the earth to tremble and striking fear into all obstructors and malevolent forces. It belongs to a series of such name-collections and is identified as the eighth in that root series. This work is Toh 638 in the Kangyur, where it falls within the category of dhāraṇī literature.

The One Hundred and Eight Names with dhāraṇī and mantra, the eighth in the root series, is complete.

In the language of India: Ārya-Vajrapāṇi-aṣṭottaraśataka-nāma-dhāraṇī-mantra-sahita. In the language of Tibet: The Noble One Hundred and Eight Names of Vajrapāṇi, Together with dhāraṇī and mantra.

Homage to the bodhisattva, the great being Vajrapāṇi.

Then the bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi uttered his own heart essence: Om vajra caṇḍa sarva duṣṭān taka, hana daha, paca hūṃ phaṭ.

No sooner had this dhāraṇī and mantra been proclaimed than the great earth trembled. All obstructors and misleaders cried out in fear, uttering sounds of distress and anguish. All those assembled in the great maṇḍala raised their voices in exclamations of wonder. The great gods and the great lords of vidyā-mantras caused a great rain of ornaments to fall. The Blessed One, his face wreathed in smiles, gazed upon the Vajra-Holder and declared: "Dispeller of hostility, do not make this assembly overly frightened."

The Vajra-Holder then addressed the Blessed One: "Blessed One, this dhāraṇī of mine is supremely secret. It is the highest of all vidyā-mantras. It turns back all obstructors. It dispels all hostility. It bestows the excellent. It bestows

prosperity. It causes enemies to become pleased. Hearing it is meaningful. Reciting it is meaningful. Venerating it is meaningful. It generates power. It makes the form beautiful. It generates confidence. It causes lordship to be attained. It makes one endowed with wealth. It confers mastery. It destroys hostility. It makes hostility collapse. It removes poison. It causes victory. It causes joy. It causes supreme joy. It causes clarity of mind. It destroys pride. It defeats adversaries. It pacifies evil. It purifies transgressions that have been committed. It pacifies the afflictions of attachment and the rest. It turns back the boundless hells. It pacifies evil dreams. It pacifies inauspiciousness. It generates splendor. It makes good fortune arise. It causes all sentient beings to rejoice. It confers mastery over others. It bestows whatever is desired. It makes all qualities flourish abundantly. When there is too much rain and when rain does not fall, it thoroughly pacifies harm caused by the seasons. In times of great war, great plague, great conflict, fears of the non-human and the like, hostility, sorcery and harmful spells, great zombie conjurations, banishment, and times when life is threatened, when great terrors arise — rising at dawn, bathing the body, putting on white clothing, facing east and gazing upon the face of the Blessed One, the Vajra-Holder, and reciting this seven times — by that mere recitation one will be freed from all fears, will also attain great accomplishment, and will be victorious in all directions. There is nothing higher than this great dhāraṇī for the protection, refuge, and shelter of sentient beings."

Then the entire assembly was filled with wonder, and they praised the Vajra-Holder with the one hundred and eight names:

Vajrasattva, the great bodhisattva.
Vajra King, the greatly blissful.
Vajra Terror, greatly delighted.
Vajra Essence, the greatly powerful.
Vajra Turbulence, the great lasso.
Great Vajra, the greatly powerful.
Vajra Terrifier, who causes terror.
The Vajra hūṃ, who is hūṃ itself.
Vajra of the underground, the terrifying.
Vajra of attachment, greatly attached.
Lasso of attachment, exceedingly swift.
Red-handed one, whose hand is long.
Red-eyed one, possessed of eyes.

Vajra protuberance, greatly protuberant.
Adorned with blue hair bound at the crown.
Blue sword, the great sword.
Possessor of the blue maṇḍala.
Eye of the protuberance, blue-headed.

Possessor of great radiance and the light of the protuberance.
Blue Vajra, of incomparable power.
Vajra of joy, the greatly powerful.
Wrathful Vajra, the greatly wrathful.
The Dispeller, who clears the pride of the wrathful.
The eyes of wrath are supremely praised.
The Wrathful One, who clears away all classes of obstructors.
Bearing a bow, bearing a lasso.
The splendor of the vajra is utterly extinguished.
Holding a staff, bearing a vajra sword.
Completely vanquishing with a vajra lasso.
Vajra wheel, the great wheel.
Roaring a fearful sound, supremely wrathful.
Of variegated form, painted with dots.
Producer of majesty, maker of renown.
Difficult to endure, unbearable to touch.
Who cuts down the sinful and all obstructors.
The greatly fierce, Vajra Wrathful.
The Subduer, who achieves fierce subjugation.
Unfathomable in depth, journeying afar.
Ocean of jewels, supremely joyful.
Endowed with the mountains and hosts of the ocean.
The sacred Ti-se, the peak of the great mountain.
Laughter with great laughter.
His domain spans three immeasurable eons.
Supreme holder of vidyā mantras, vajra-possessing.
Great holder of vidyā mantras, sovereign lord.
Wearing a garment of willow leaves and red roots.
Clad in protuberance-garment, delighting in the high.
Rākṣasa, guardian, and fierce one.
Delighting in ornaments of flower garlands.

Great sun, light of the sun.
Scattering hundreds of rays of light.
The Liberator, protector, and teacher.
Worshipped by the most supreme of the supremely excellent.
Great-throated, whose throat is blue.
Beautiful melody, beautiful face, the sacred one.
Great crown, the radiance of the vajra.
Fully endowed with excellence, of pure mind.
Possessed of great gnosis, greatly protective.
Swift as the wind, with a vast domain.
Chief Liberator, gone beyond.
Freed from fear, supremely terrifying.
Great king, holding a jewel at the crown.
Great weapons, weapons of every kind.
The one great way of the three worlds.
Seeing the three, three-peaked at the crown, three crests.
God of desire, bearing the mark of great splendor.
Devourer, who causes terror.
The lofty, of supreme form, three-faced.
Unhesitating, arisen from existence.
Eternally delighting in stars, lord of times.
Who causes the royal lineage of the constellations to increase.
The king who is the great mantra-holder.
Skilled sovereign over all obstructors.
Body pure as vaiḍūrya, without blemish.
Beautiful, generating power, possessing various strengths.
Producer of joy, who brings about delight.
Supreme holder of the Three Jewels.
The Great God (Śiva), the great hero.
Steadfast hero, at ease.
Great bliss, who severs bondage.
Possessor of the skill of binding firmly.
Bearing great weapons of every kind, crowned.
Bringing delight to the assembly of vidyā-mantra holders.
Long arm of the great lotus.
Born from the lotus, supreme among lotuses.
The great black one, the great spirit.

Greatly fierce, the greatly thunderous.
The great wind and the arising of laughter.
Complete with a hundred vajra weapons.
Resolute, devoted to delight in endeavor.
Lord of the hosts of great spirits.
Peaceful sovereign, vajra weapon.
Thoroughly shattering the summit of a cliff.
Son of the Victors, of great form.
Adorned with a maṇḍala of vajras.
Who burns with a vajra iron arrow.
Thoroughly purifying with a vajra arrow.
Meaningful Vajra, sovereign of vajra.
Vajra Lord, vajra strength.
Pure gnosis, the Great Vehicle.
Who has found the means, possessed of great compassion.
The great vajra, playful one.
Beautiful eyes, the wide-seeing one.
Vajra bell, of pure vision.
Dear one, beloved one, who knows the pledges.
The great vajra, the protector.
Vajra of the underground, who causes terror.
The great vajra, who proclaims great laughter.
A bunch of flowers, brilliantly luminous.
Pure, of pure fare, son among sons.
Delightful, of good fortune, the pure one.
Of variegated nature, supreme among all gods.
Endowed with the maṇḍala of vajra hosts.
Vajra crown ornament, possessor of wisdom.

Supremely beautiful in vajra array,
Beautiful, thoroughly pure.
Like the great wind at the end of an age.
Hero, bearer of the great secret.
Renowned as the supreme bearer of vidyā mantras.
The secret one, who speaks secrets.
Joy of the assembly of men and women.
Vajra of thunder, who roars with great sound.

Vajra sound, the utterly victorious.
Vajra iron hook, greatly pleased.
Blazing vajra, burning intensely.
Robed in garments adorned with jewels.
Adorned with garlands of incense and flowers.
Earrings and bracelets fastened at the head.
Teacher who reveals the teaching of the buddhas.
King equal to all buddhas.
Great Lord, of vast renown.
Maṇḍala master, possessor of maṇḍalas.
Teacher who reveals the maṇḍala of the buddhas.
Bound all around with crowns and diadems.
Adorned with varied ornaments.

Thus was Vajrapāṇi, the protector and great lord, praised with one hundred and eight names.

Then Vajrāmogha spoke: This, the root text of the vajra names, adorned with vajra secrets, with its one hundred and eight vajra names, bears the title Vajrāmogha. It averts all hatred. Whoever holds these one hundred and eight names with faith will obtain all attainments and will be completely freed from all faults. The mighty Vajrapāṇi will always follow close behind as a constant attendant. The great qualities of Vajrapāṇi are such that whoever rises early in the morning and recites them will be freed from all wrongdoing and will be liberated from all lower realms. Whoever rises early and recites this supreme secret mantra, spoken at the outset, will cause kings, ministers, townspeople, and relatives alike to rejoice. Whoever recites this supreme praise will gain sovereignty over the entire world, all wrongdoing will be exhausted, and life and merit will increase. One will thereby obtain whatever excellent happiness one desires. Whoever rises early and recites these names in the presence of Vajrapāṇi will without any doubt come to have whatever one wishes. When one recites the one hundred and eight names, even obstructing spirits, misleading demons, and all terrifying kings will be unable to overpower one. Whatever wise person recites the supreme one hundred and eight names will obtain a beautiful form, the arising of strength, and the increase of happiness. Whoever steadfastly and purely recites these one hundred and eight names will, in brief, obtain the happiness of vast qualities.

The noble Vajrapāṇi's...

Translator's Notes

- The phrase "अपराधान्मोक्षाय" rendered as "turns back the boundless hells" could also mean "averts the actions of immediate retribution" (the five heinous acts, ānantarya). The context of purification strongly favors the ānantarya reading, but since either is possible and the doctrinal stakes differ, it is worth noting.

[illegible]

- Ti-se is the Tibetan name for Mount Kailash, rendered here in its classical Tibetan form since it functions as a proper name in context. The phrase "great mountain" renders lhun po, which also carries the sense of Sumeru or Mount Meru; the passage appears to identify Ti-se with a sacred cosmic peak rather than making a Meru equation explicit.

The term rendered "protuberance" throughout this and the preceding passage represents a topknot or cranial protuberance (uṣṇīṣa, Skt. uṣṇīṣa), a major mark of a great being, here applied to a wrathful deity in a tantric context.

"Rākṣasa" translates *srin po*, a class of fierce supernatural beings; "guardian" translates *srung po*. Both appear as epithets of the deity praised.

The line rendered "of pure fare, son among sons" is somewhat compressed in the Tibetan; the rendering reflects the most natural doctrinal reading without over-interpretation.

- The text ends mid-phrase with "The noble Vajrapāṇi's" indicating the passage continues beyond what was provided. The epithet Vajrāmogha rendered as a name for the speaker corresponds to "Vajra of Amogha" or "Infallible Vajra," consistent with the text's title and the identification of the speaker as Vajrāmogha (the personification of the text's title). The phrase rendered "rises early in the morning" translates a formulaic expression meaning to recite at dawn, a standard prescriptive context in dhāraṇī literature.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.